Why I Don't Max Out My Bench Press

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 18, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/dRt47UpVmSY Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, nearly 42, avoids one-rep-max bench pressing because it poses high injury risk and isn't the only measure of strength — he prefers rep-based testing at a set weight.

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- 🏋️ Why He Skips the Max Bench
- 📏 A Different Way to Measure Strength
- ⚠️ Age and Injury Risk

🏋️ Why He Skips the Max Bench 0:00

- Has nothing to prove by chasing a one-rep max
- Has personally witnessed many people get injured attempting to lift as much as they possibly can
- Not interested in that approach "right now"

📏 A Different Way to Measure Strength 0:00

- Prefers measuring strength by **how many reps he can complete at a given weight**
- Draws comparison to the NFL Combine
  - The Combine tests how many times an athlete can bench a set weight (225 lbs) rather than asking for a one-rep max
  - He views this as a more meaningful and practical strength metric
- Notes that different testing methods recruit different types of muscle fibers and reflect different kinds of strength
  - Implies rep-based endurance strength and max-effort strength are distinct qualities

⚠️ Age and Injury Risk 0:21

- Will be **42 years old** this year
- At his age, attempting to see how many hundreds of pounds he can lift feels like "a recipe for injury"
- The risk-reward calculation shifts with age — protecting the body takes priority over ego-driven max attempts